



IELTS SPEAKING PART 2

QUESTIONS &

ANSWERS

KEITH O'HARE



About the Author

Keith runs The Keith Speaking Academy. He has been working in international education for over 20 years as a teacher, teacher trainer, and education manager.

He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.



How do you handle IELTS Speaking Part 2?

I think there are 2 ways that work really well.

In this PDF, I will show you how to do both and I will illustrate them with a couple of part 2 questions and answers.

The 2 approaches are

1. The Structure Approach

2. The Free Flow Approach

Let's look at the first one.

1. The Structured Approach

In this approach, you take the following steps:

- **Get a general idea of what to talk about**
- **Follow the bullet points**
- **Get a brief idea for each bullet point**
- **Make a few notes**
- **Prepare your first sentence.**

Tip:

Remember when you start speaking, you can look at your task card and your notes, and use these to help you talk.

Let's take an example with a real IELTS Speaking Part 2 Question

"Describe a positive change you made in your life"

You should say,

- **What it was**
- **Why you made that change**
- **Who you did it with**

And explain how you felt about it

Below you can see the kind of notes you may make.

Remember, you are going to follow each bullet point, and have an idea of what to say for each one.



Here is the sample answer

You can watch the video of this here: <https://vimeo.com/771597531>

Language Key

Coherence phrases in **BLUE**

Useful Vocabulary in **RED**

Useful Grammar in **GREEN**

The positive change that I would like to tell you about is when I decided to start getting up really early in the morning and going for **a brisk walk**.

The reason I made this change, well, is because previously, I was **under a lot of strain at work**. I mean, I **had a lot on my plate**.

I was feeling **stressed out**, even **burnt out** a lot of the time, and I noticed my physical health and mental health were **deteriorating**.

So I went to see the doctor and the doctor gave me some advice.

He said, basically **it's not so much** your physical health is the problem, **it's** your mental health.

One of the best things you can do is go out into the countryside for one hour every day, get out of the kind of the rut you are in at work, get out of that environment, into the countryside, and just do some simple exercise, walking or cycling.

And so following the doctor's advice, I decided to make this change.

When it comes to who I did it with, well, I do it alone, actually.

I must admit, my wife was very supportive. She encouraged me to do this.

She said, "You know, I'll **do the school run**. I'll look after the kids. You go and do your walk in the morning." **Which I did**.

And yeah, when it comes to how I felt about it, I felt absolutely great. It was really beneficial.

I noticed **a marked improvement** in my health and wellbeing and my mental health.

I wasn't lazy all the time.

I just had more energy, so I felt really good about this change.

Vocabulary

- a **brisk walk** = a walk at a fairly quick pace
- To be **under a lot of strain** at work = to be under stress
- To **have a lot on my plate** = to have a lot of tasks to do
- To be **stressed out** = to feel stress
- To **burn out** = to collapse due to too much stress
- To **deteriorate** = to get worse
- To **do the school run** = to take the children to school
- a **marked improvement** = a significant improvement

2. The Free Flow Approach

In this approach, you follow these steps:

- Forget the bullet points
- Focus on the overall question
- Get an idea of what you will talk about
- Decide 1 or 2 details you will talk about
- Make a few notes
- Prepare your first sentence
- Start speaking and then go with the flow

Sometimes, you can produce your best English, by not worrying too much about all the details and language you want to use, but just focussing on an idea you want to communicate and start speaking.

Of course, it helps to have prepared 1 or 2 details, but when you speak, just go with the flow.

When you go with the flow, your fluency will increase, and Part 2 is a key part to show your level of fluency.

When you speak like this, you will probably notice your linking words become very simple, such as the following,

And, then, and, so, and, but, finally.

This is fine, as this represents how we talk in reality in natural spoken English

Let's take an example with a real IELTS Speaking Part 2 Question

"Describe a time someone asked for your opinion"

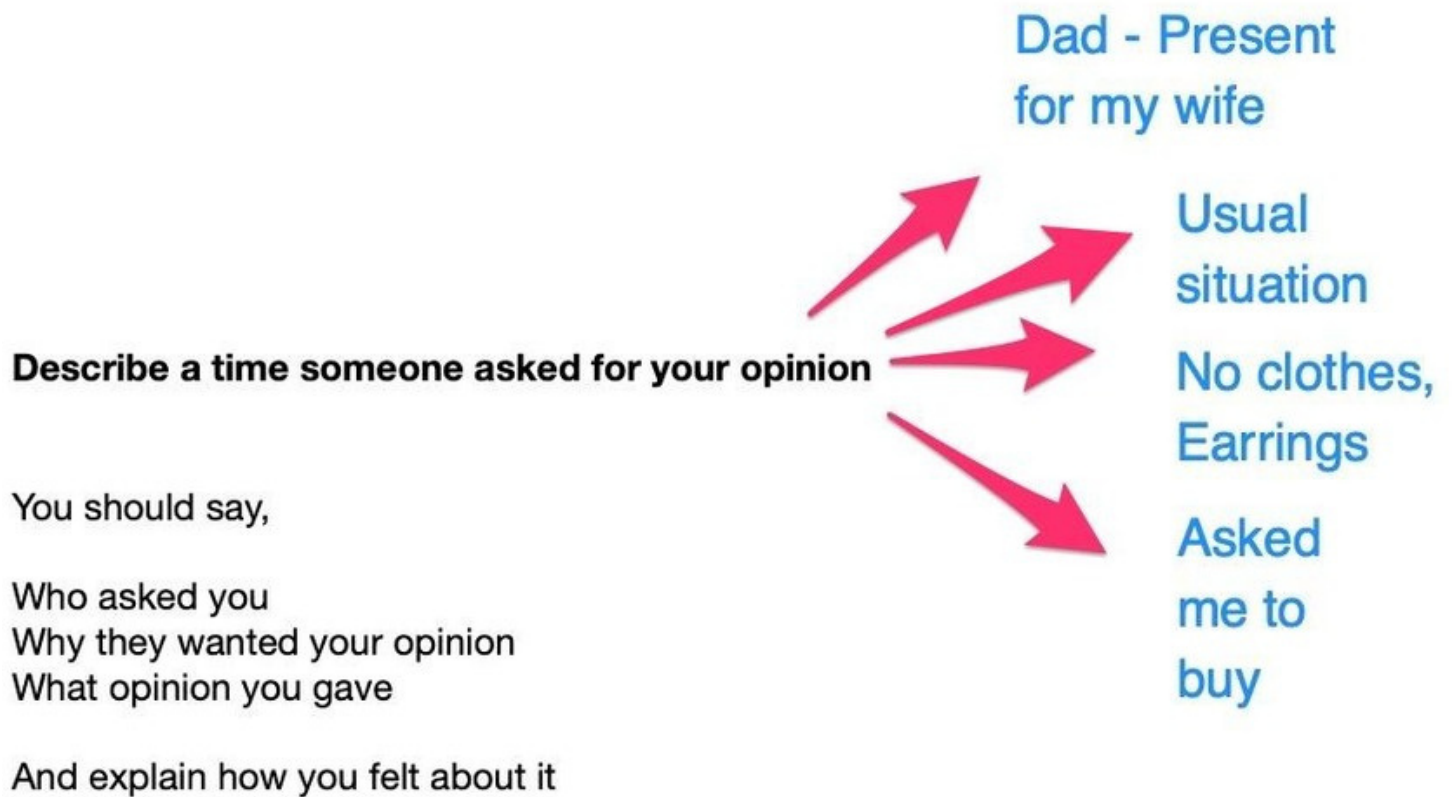
You should say,

- **Who asked you**
- **Why they wanted your opinion**
- **What opinion you gave**

And explain how you felt about it

Below you can see the kind of notes you may make.

Remember, you are NOT going to follow each bullet point, but you will have an idea of 1 or 2 details you may talk about.



Here is the sample answer

You can watch the video of this here: <https://vimeo.com/771597952>

Language Key

Coherence phrases in **BLUE**

Useful Vocabulary in **RED**

Useful Grammar in **GREEN**

So I'd like to tell you about the time that my father asked me for my opinion and it was about my wife's birthday present.

So this is a very **run-of-the-mill** situation where my wife's birthday is coming up and my father just doesn't know what to buy her.

This is made doubly complicated because we live abroad, so he can't **keep track of** what she has and what she doesn't have and maybe her tastes have changed.

And also, you know, my dad's **getting on**.

He's **80-odd**, so it's hard for him to get out and buy presents and be creative and so on.

So what happens every year, we go through this routine, he calls me up and says, "What should I buy for your wife?"

And so this year **I said**, "Well listen, don't buy clothes because there's always a problem there with the size, getting the wrong size and her taste in clothes changes like the weather. So that's difficult."

I said, "Earrings are a winner.

You can't go wrong with earrings 'cause it's always the same size and different styles match different clothes and she loves earrings."

So he said, "That's great, excellent. Could you go and buy them for me?"

And that makes me laugh because then I go out and buy them and I wrap them up and I present them and I say, of course, "This is from my father."

I think this is quite a funny situation.

I mean, we go through this **rigmarole** every year. It's the same phone call, it's the same answer and it's quite comical.

But I guess I feel **flattered**. Flattered that my dad is asking for my opinion, but it's quite amusing also.

So yeah, that's the time that my father asked for my opinion.

Vocabulary

- Run-of-the-mill (adj.) = Ordinary
- To keep track of = to monitor and follow progress or changes
- To be getting on = to be getting older
- Eighty odd = approximately eighty
- A rigmarole = a complicated, annoying routine/ procedure
- To be flattered = to feel honoured, pleased

Grammar

1) It is quite common in natural spoken English, especially when telling a story or anecdote to use this format,

I said, “__”

Then she said,

“___” I said, “____”

2) We can also use fronting to add emphasis.

Instead of saying

'Every year we do this'

We can say,

'What happens every year is, we do this'



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